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LETTERS TO MY SON

On Legacy

16 letters

Father

A father's letters, worth keeping.

A word before you begin

My son,

A man is a bridge between those before him and those who follow. These letters are on what endures after the money is gone.

Read one a day. Sit with it. Let it change one small thing in how you live.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

A family's fortune rarely survives three generations: one builds, one keeps, one forgets.

Money is the easiest capital to pass on and the easiest to lose. Character is the hard kind — and the kind that lasts.

Hand down the habits, not just the holdings.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

The real wealth of a family is its people, not its money.

Bank accounts empty. What endures is the human,
intellectual, and moral capital you grow in your
children.

Invest in the person; the portfolio is downstream.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Measure your family's wealth by the strength of its members, not the size of its accounts.

A house full of capable, decent people is rich though the vault be modest.

Grow people first; everything else compounds from there.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Inherited money without inherited wisdom is a curse
wearing a gift's clothing.

Hand a fortune to an unprepared heir and you have handed
him his undoing.

Prepare the heir before you prepare the inheritance.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Every generation must choose the inheritance anew, or it dies with its builder.

Nothing passes down on its own. What is not re-chosen is lost.

Make your son want what you are leaving him.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Look at fathers and sons today, and you wonder which is the greater misfortune.

A name is not inherited; it is honoured or wasted by the one who carries it next.

Earn the name before you pass it on.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Build a family of strong individuals, not a kingdom that swallows them.

The house that erases its members to feed itself does not last a third life.

Let each one become whole; the family grows from that.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

A family rises and falls in three lives: one builds, one keeps, one forgets.

Money is the easiest thing to pass down and the easiest to lose.

Hand down the habits, not only the holdings.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Each generation must choose the inheritance anew, or it dies with its builder.

Nothing passes down on its own; what is not re-chosen is lost.

Make your son want what you are leaving him.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

A name is not inherited; it is honoured or wasted by the one who carries it.

Look at fathers and sons today and you see how easily it is squandered.

Earn the name before you pass it on.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

A good name is the one estate no tax can touch and no thief can take.

Spend a lifetime building it; guard it like the treasure it is.

Protect the name; it outlives the fortune.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Tell your children the stories of those who came before.

A family that forgets its origins loses the compass that steered it.

Keep the old stories alive; they carry the map.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

We are not the owners of our days but the stewards of them.

What you call yours is only lent, to be passed on improved.

Leave the field richer than you found it.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

The strongest thing a family can pass down is the habit of becoming.

Fortunes spent on comfort fade; the appetite for growth endures.

Hand down the hunger, not just the harvest.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

A family is an enterprise of love that must be governed,
not assumed.

What is never tended quietly falls apart, however strong
it began.

Tend the bond on purpose, generation after generation.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

You borrow your name from your fathers and lend it to
your sons.

Hand it on cleaner than you received it, or be the link
that failed.

Return the name unstained.

Yours faithfully,

Father

Keep going

If these served you, there is more.

- A new letter every day — @letters_to_son_eng
- The weekly letter — comment LETTERS to join.
- The full collection and printed keepsakes — coming soon.

Carry these well. One day you may write your own.

Yours faithfully,

Father